

CASH FLOW MASTERY

# Course Curriculum

Understand where your cash is going, see cash problems 13 weeks ahead, and leave with a practical cash action plan.

A practical four-week programme for SME owners and managing directors

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# A clearer view of your cash

Cash Flow Mastery is designed for business owners who may be profitable or growing, yet still feel that cash is constantly tight. It turns finance concepts into a practical operating routine that can be used every week.

## By the end of the programme, you will be able to:

**01**

### Understand cash

Explain why profit and cash are different - and why a profitable business can still run out of money.

**02**

### Find blockages

Map where cash becomes trapped across customers, stock, work in progress, suppliers and overhead.

**03**

### Forecast 13 weeks

Build a working 13-week cash-flow forecast and identify your lowest cash point before it becomes urgent.

**04**

### Act every week

Use scenarios, decisions and a weekly cash meeting to turn the forecast into action.

## How the programme works

| FORMAT                     | WHAT TO EXPECT                                                                                      |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Four guided weeks</b>   | Short self-paced lessons arranged around one practical business outcome each week.                  |
| <b>Four live sessions</b>  | Weekly group application sessions with Carl to challenge assumptions and turn learning into action. |
| <b>Practical toolkit</b>   | A diagnostic, worksheets, planning tools and the 13-week cash-flow forecast workbook.               |
| <b>Action-led learning</b> | Every week ends with a specific output for your own business - not another folder of theory.        |

START HERE

# Set your baseline

Begin with a clear picture of where you are today, how the programme works and what you will build over the next four weeks.

- Welcome from Carl and the programme outcomes.
- How to use the lessons, workbook and live application sessions.
- Complete the baseline Cash Visibility Diagnostic.
- Download the learner workbook and 13-week cash-flow forecast template.

WEEK 1

# Profit Is Not Cash

WEEKLY OUTCOME

**Understand why a profitable or rapidly growing business can still run out of cash, and identify the warning signs in your own business.**

## Lessons

- The difference between profit and cash.
- Can a profitable business still fail?
- Why 'Cash Is King' is more than a slogan.
- The cash danger of growing too quickly.

|                    |                                                                                               |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PRACTICAL EXERCISE | Identify the three biggest cash warning signs currently visible in your business.             |
| LIVE APPLICATION   | Work through common profit-versus-cash situations and apply the lessons to real SME examples. |
| YOUR OUTPUT        | A personal cash-warning summary highlighting the issues that require attention first.         |

# Find the Cash Blockage

WEEKLY OUTCOME

**Map your operating cash cycle and select immediate actions that can release or protect cash.**

This week moves from diagnosis to action. The objective is to identify where cash is being delayed, absorbed or spent without sufficient control.

## Lessons

- The cash cycle in plain English.
- Where cash becomes trapped in customers, stock, work in progress, suppliers and overhead.
- Practical cash quick wins.
- How to prioritise cash actions by impact and urgency.

|                    |                                                                                              |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PRACTICAL EXERCISE | Complete the Cash-Cycle Map and select your five priority cash actions for the next 30 days. |
| LIVE APPLICATION   | Challenge the priorities, test whether they are realistic and improve the action plan.       |
| YOUR OUTPUT        | A completed cash-cycle map and a focused list of five actions with owners and target dates.  |

**Cash becomes manageable when you can see where it gets stuck.**

# Build Your 13-Week Forecast

WEEKLY OUTCOME      **Complete the first working version of a practical 13-week cash-flow forecast for your business.**

The forecast is designed to be practical, visible and regularly updated - not an accounting exercise that is completed once and forgotten.

## Lessons

- Cash budgeting versus cash forecasting.
- Why 13 weeks - and how to establish the opening cash position.
- Forecasting customer receipts from revenue and outstanding invoices.
- Forecasting materials, direct costs and supplier payments.
- Forecasting payroll, overhead and other cash outflows.
- Bringing the forecast together and identifying the lowest cash point.
- Guided demonstration using the approved Excel workbook.

|                    |                                                                                                |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PRACTICAL EXERCISE | Build and self-check the first version of your own 13-week forecast.                           |
| LIVE APPLICATION   | Review assumptions, timing errors, weak points and the decisions revealed by the forecast.     |
| YOUR OUTPUT        | A usable 13-week cash-flow forecast showing expected weekly cash balances and pressure points. |

# Run the Business from Cash

WEEKLY OUTCOME      **Use the forecast as a weekly management tool and establish a repeatable cash decision-making rhythm.**

## Lessons

- Building base, downside and upside scenarios.
- The weekly cash meeting and forecast update routine.
- Turning an early forecast warning into a management decision.
- Building the 30-day implementation plan.
- Repeating the Cash Visibility Diagnostic to measure progress.

|                    |                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PRACTICAL EXERCISE | Complete the 30-day implementation plan and define the first weekly cash meeting.                                   |
| LIVE APPLICATION   | Implementation clinic: test actions, commitments and the management routine that will continue after the programme. |
| YOUR OUTPUT        | A scenario-tested forecast, a weekly cash-management rhythm and a practical 30-day action plan.                     |

**The goal is not to predict the future perfectly. It is to see pressure early enough to act.**

# Leave with a working cash system

The programme closes by turning the four weeks of learning into a simple operating discipline for the next 30 days and beyond.

- Complete your final 30-day Cash Action Plan.
- Repeat the Cash Visibility Diagnostic and identify the next improvement priority.
- Commit to the first weekly cash meeting and forecast update.
- Complete the programme feedback survey.

## Your Cash Flow Mastery toolkit

| RESOURCE                          | PURPOSE                                                            |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cash Visibility Diagnostic</b> | Assess current visibility, controls and decision readiness.        |
| <b>Cash-Cycle Map</b>             | See where money is delayed or absorbed across the operating cycle. |
| <b>13-Week Forecast Workbook</b>  | Forecast weekly receipts, payments and cash balances.              |
| <b>Assumptions Checklist</b>      | Improve the quality and consistency of forecast inputs.            |
| <b>Weekly Cash Meeting Agenda</b> | Turn the forecast into a structured management routine.            |
| <b>30-Day Implementation Plan</b> | Convert insights into named actions, owners and deadlines.         |

**Finance is the language of business. You do not need to become an accountant - but you should understand what your business is telling you.**

Cash Flow Mastery provides practical business education. It does not constitute bespoke financial, tax, legal or investment advice, and individual outcomes depend on each participant's circumstances and implementation.